

# A calmer inbox. Clearer work.

Keep this beside you while you set up or manage a client inbox.

## The goal

Make every message easy to understand, easy to act on and easy to find again.  
A clean inbox does not mean every message disappears. It means every message has a clear next move.

### REPLY NOW

A time-sensitive customer issue, meeting change or question you can answer safely.

### DRAFT FOR REVIEW

A message that needs the client's voice, approval or decision.

### TURN INTO A TASK

Work that needs research, files, follow-up or more time.

### FILE / ARCHIVE

A receipt, reference or resolved thread that needs no action.

# Learn the client's rules first

Use these questions before you add labels, filters, rules or folders.

## Client preference questions

- ☐ Which senders, topics or deadlines are urgent?
- ☐ Which messages can I answer, and which need your review?
- ☐ What tone, sign-off and response time do you expect?
- ☐ Which labels, folders or filters already matter to you?
- ☐ Who else may need to see or own a message?

## Safety check

Confirm access and permissions before you work. Never change forwarding rules, account settings or sharing permissions without clear client approval.

If a message feels sensitive or unclear, draft it and ask.

# Read. Decide. Make the next action visible.

Use this small routine every time you open a client inbox.

1

## Read the full thread

Context can change the right response.

2

## Check urgency

Look for deadlines, customer impact, calendar conflicts and preferences.

3

## Choose the owner

You, the client, a teammate or a future task.

4

## Record the next action

Reply, draft, task, calendar item or file.

### Reply check

Name the action you are taking. Give a clear next update when useful. Check tone, accuracy and who needs to know.

# Client inbox simulation

Use this page while you complete the lesson exercise in the portal.

For each message, record the action and the reason.

## 1. Late delivery complaint

Action: \_\_\_\_\_

Next step: \_\_\_\_\_

## 2. Meeting confirmation request

Action: \_\_\_\_\_

Next step: \_\_\_\_\_

## 3. Useful industry newsletter

Action: \_\_\_\_\_

Next step: \_\_\_\_\_

## 4. Refund question with missing details

Action: \_\_\_\_\_

Next step: \_\_\_\_\_

## 5. Internal task that needs research

Action: \_\_\_\_\_

Next step: \_\_\_\_\_

## 6. Receipt for a completed order

Action: \_\_\_\_\_

Next step: \_\_\_\_\_

## Reflection

Which decision was hardest, and what client preference would help you make it with confidence?